Judge Q&A — the questions a Citi, M-KOPA or DRW judge will ask, answered in one breath each

Every answer below points at something live. Where the honest answer is "not yet", it says so.

"You removed credit risk?" No. The advance is a **waterfall on witnessed inflow** — the next verified payout auto-splits at the published fraction — with **recourse on the Sage-routed remainder**. A borrower can stop using Sage; what we remove is the *information* problem, not the risk. The terms are published arithmetic on `/lender` — open it prefilled for a real record: https://sagepays.xyz/lender?wallet=0xccbfb9bba88f282282a29aa1338175cc835e768d — never a score.

"Where does the credit data come from? Self-reported cash flow is worthless." It is not reported at all. Sage *witnesses* the work — browses the product, fetches the artifact, reads the chain — and the vault only releases money for work that passed. The record is the byproduct of payment, so it cannot be self-inflated: `/record/<wallet>` and its JSON at `/api/record/<wallet>`.

"How do I know the agent isn't rubber-stamping?" 40% of judged submissions are refused, on a public ledger, with reasons (`/explorer`). Two adversarial batteries run the production judge against attack fixtures *and* honest-work fixtures: P-JUDGE zero wrong auto-pays across 57 rows; P-WORK 14 attacks with zero leaks and 12 honest submissions with zero false holds. A judge model is promoted only on that evidence.

"What stops one person farming ten wallets?" On public work a slot is claimed behind a one-time World ID proof of personhood — no name, document or country reaches Sage, only a nullifier — and the slot and payout caps count the person across every wallet the proof, the chain or their own declaration ties together. Underneath: exact and paraphrase dedup on reports; a fingerprint of the fetched deliverable so a copied page with the marker swapped is held; GitHub provenance (a fork, or a repo older than the gig, is held); wallet-freshness and funding-graph signals — a real 4-wallet rotation cluster was caught on-chain in August; a per-wallet payout cap; a daily submit limit; the vault's own replay protection. Every one is a hold for a human, never a silent rejection.

"Can the AI move money it shouldn't?" No model computes an amount. The vault derives the reward from the mission, enforces the budget, per-mission caps and replay, and can refuse. On Starknet a refusal is a successful transaction that moved nothing and wrote a code. The agent proposes; the vault disposes.

"7–9% fees to under 1% — really?" Recipients keep 100% of the vault-derived reward; the gas is Sage's cost (≈ $0.00000002 per payout on GOAT). The payer pays a flat $0.10 per settlement over x402 — $1.30 collected on 13 settlements, against $5.09 a 7–9% corridor would have taken on the same volume. The outcomes page computes both live and says what it has not measured yet (`/outcomes`).

"Settlement speed?" Median 3 minutes from submission to settled payment, *verification included*; p90 2 hours; 79% within the hour. Chain confirmation itself is seconds.

"KYC/AML?" OFAC SDN screening at every EVM door (web and chat submission, preflight, manual release) from a vendored, dated snapshot — never a runtime API on the money path; the SDN list carries no Starknet addresses, so the private rail is screened at its EVM funding side only — plus wallet pseudonymity and the Sybil controls above. Named-recipient allowlists where an operator needs them. We do not claim identity KYC.

"Fiat? Most of the region can't hold USDC." The settlement door is an interface with a typed contract: a fiat disbursement cannot ship without producing the identical verified credit event. The corridor quote is real; the disburse refuses in words today. Licensed-partner implementation is pending compliance onboarding — stated as such everywhere it appears.

"Multi-currency?" Obligations can be priced in 14 currencies, the Caribbean's own first (J$, TT$, EC$, Bds$, HTG, RD$, G$, B$, BZ$, SRD) plus the diaspora senders (CAD, GBP, EUR), converted once at a stamped, source-attributed rate. Settlement is always the USD stablecoin; the founder never does exchange arithmetic. The first J$ obligation settled on 6 Sep — J$1,600 in two milestones of J$800 (→ $5.05 @ 158.27), receipts `0x72838f…83f8` and `0x2337af…bb54`. Intra-regional corridor flow is still one book, **not yet a corridor**.

"CARICOM FX matching?" Netting becomes real on our own book the day obligations exist in two currencies; inventing counterparties this week would be an app, not infrastructure. One honest slide, no build.

"Two chains — which one is Sage?" One account, two rails, chosen by purpose rather than by chain. Starknet is the rail Sage leads with: the Cairo vault derives the reward and a recipient collects privately behind a commitment. GOAT Network carries public receipts and the treasury, because that is where the email-embedded wallet and the mandate policy live today. A founder is asked "public receipts or private-capable", never "which chain"; the settlement dispatcher branches in exactly one place. The registry is the only file that names a chain, so a fiat-reachable rail (Base or Polygon, where a card onramp exists) is a factory deployment and a registry entry after the deadlines — written up in `docs/strategy/fiat-door-and-rails.md`.

"A worker who signed in with an email — how do they ever get the money out?" From inside Sage. Their record page and Settings show the wallet Sage keeps for them (deposit is the address), the live USDC balance on GOAT, and a withdrawal to any address they name: the wallet signs an EIP-3009 authorization — the Privy embedded wallet for an email account, a browser wallet through its own prompt — and Sage's operator submits it and pays the gas, because a wallet paid only in USDC holds no BTC. The same primitive the Telegram cash-out has used since August; the signature pins from, to, value and a single-use nonce, so the operator can only submit what the worker signed.

"Privacy for banking-shy earners?" A Starknet rail where the agent decides the payout in public and the recipient collects privately — escrow keyed by a commitment, gasless claim, a shielded note if they hold a registered wallet — and a signed earnings *floor* a lender can verify without seeing the payments.

"Who has actually been paid?" 24 distinct people, 39 payouts, $63.60 across two mainnet rails, every row a transaction; an autonomous third-party agent earned under the same rules and has a credit file (`/record/0xccbf…768d`). The first *advance* was drawn and repaid on 6 Sep: $1.85 against $5.05 of verified inflow, taken from the record page in one click twelve minutes after the first J$ milestone paid, repaid in full from the next payout eight minutes later by the waterfall (`adv-1997e6ea-454`, `/record/0x04f1…f434`). A rehearsal with our own wallet standing in for the seller; the money, the escrows and the waterfall were real.

"What breaks if you disappear?" Vaults are founder-owned on-chain; the operator can only settle inside their limits; refusals cost nothing; the code is open source. The record API is a plain JSON contract a lender can consume without Sage's UI.